INCH-POUND

MIL-C-60418B (AR)
AMENDMENT 5
1 September 1992
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 4
31 May 1991

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHARGE, PROPELLING, 155MM, M3A1,
LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-C-60418B (AR) dated 23 March 1982, and is approved for use by the US Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 2

2.1.2: Delete "9331257 - Packing and Marking for Container, Ammo, Metal PA 94: for Charge, Propelling, 155MM, M3A1" and substitute "7548187 - Packing and Marking of Metal Containers for Propelling Charges, Assembly and Details". (This reinstates the use of the round end container, dwg 7548187, which was replaced by the square end container, dwg 9331257, by Amend 2, dated 19 Jul 83).

2.1.2: Add the following new drawings:

"12913757	- Packing and Marking for Container, Ammo, Metal: PA 132 for Charge, Propelling, 155MM, M3A1 (alternate)
19-48-4231/53B	- Unitization Procedure for Ammunition and Components Packed in Cylindrical Metal or Plastic Containers on 4-Way Entry Metal Pallets"

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PAGE 3

3.3.1: Add the following sentences:

"When the propellant weight is determined prior to loading into increment bags, the propellant weight tolerance shall apply. When the propellant weight is determined using a loaded increment, the loaded increment tolerance shall apply."

Delete the table in its entirety and substitute the following:

"Incr. No.	Propellant Weight Tolerance (±) ozs.	Loaded Increment Tolerance (±)ozs.
1	0.05	0.10
2	0.02	0.04
3	0.02	0.04
4	0.05	0.08
5	0.05	0.08"

3.3.2: Delete "ball powder igniter (BPI)" and substitute "spheroidal propellant igniter (SPI)".

PAGE 4

* Add the following paragraph:

"3.7.1 First article test. Test samples shall be withdrawn from the first lot produced by the contractor and tested in accordance with all the requirements of this specification and with Table III. Until the first article test has been performed and found to be acceptable, the contractor is in no way authorized by the Government to initiate second lot production unless otherwise directed by the contracting officer."

PAGE 5

4.3.1: Delete "9331257" and substitute "7548187". (This reinstates the use of the round end container, dwg 7548187, which was replaced by the square end container, dwg 9331257, by Amend 2, dated 19 Jul 83).

PAGE 8

TABLE II, first article inspection: Delete "9331257" and substitute "7548187". (This reinstates the use of the round end container, dwg 7548187, which was replaced by the square end container, dwg 9331257, by Amend 2, dated 19 Jul 83).

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TABLE II, first article inspection: Delete "7548187" and substitute "7548187/12913757".

PAGE 9

4.4.1: Delete "CBI or BPI from not more than one lot number from one manufacturer" and substitute "CBI or SPI from not more than two lots from the same interfix number from one manufacturer".

* 4.4.1a: Add the following at the end of the paragraph:

"Entire lot of propellant shall be utilized in the formation of one lot of propelling charge unless otherwise approved by the contracting officer."

PAGE 15

4.4.2.6:

Critical defect 1: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI".

Major defect 101: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI".

Minor defect 201: Delete "cloth improper" and substitute "thread broken".

Delete "4.5.4" and substitute "Visual".

Minor defect 202 Delete "marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable" and substitute "any seam or opening incompletely stitched".

PAGE 18

4.4.2.9:

Critical defect 1: Delete critical defect 1 in its entirety.

Major defect 103: Delete "100%" and substitute "(a)".

Add minor defect 203: "Marking missing, misleading, unidentifiable or incorrect lot number...0.65%...3.2...Visual".

Notes: Add the following: "(a) The frequency of inspection of propellant shall depend upon the method used."

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PAGE 20

4.4.2.11:

Major defect 102: Delete "100%" and substitute "(a)".

Add minor defect 203: "Marking missing, misleading, unidentifiable or incorrect lot number...0.65%...3.2...Visual".

Notes: Add the following: "(a) The frequency of inspection of propellant shall depend upon the method used."

Drawing Number: Delete "9921257" and substitute "9221257".

PAGE 21

4.4.2.12:

Add major defect 103: "Propellant weight... (a)... 3.3... 4.5.1".

Add minor defect 203: "Marking missing, misleading, unidentifiable or incorrect lot number...0.65%...3.2...Visual".

Notes: Add the following: "(a) The frequency of inspection of propellant shall depend upon the method used."

PAGE 22

4.4.2.13:

Add major defect 103: "Propellant weight... (a)... 3.3... 4.5.1".

Add minor defect 203: "Marking missing, misleading, unidentifiable or incorrect lot number...0.65%...3.2...Visual".

Notes: Add the following: "(a) The frequency of inspection of propellant shall depend upon the method used."

PAGE 23

4.4.2.14:

Critical defect 1: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI".

Major defect 102: Delete "20" in number of samples column and substitute "14".

Major defect 103: Delete "100%" and substitute "0.40%".

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PAGE 24

4.4.1.15:

Drawing number: Delete "7548187" and substitute "7548187/12913757".

Add Major Defect 101: "Charge cannot be removed by hand... (a) ... 3.2 ... Visual/Manual".

Delete Minor Defect 202 in its entirety.

NOTES: Add the following "(a) One sample from every eight hours production".

PAGE 25

4.4.2.16:

Drawing number: Delete "7548187" and substitute "7548187/12913757".

Minor Defect 201: Add "(a)" to the number of samples column.

NOTES: Add the following: "(a) Test plugs may be greased in bulk prior to assembly of containers, and plugs will be inspected by Quality Assurance personnel for acceptability".

PAGE 26

4.5.1: Delete 4.5.1 in its entirety and substitute the following:

"4.5.1 Propellant weight (see 3.3). Any increment which fails to comply with the applicable requirement shall be classeddefective and removed from the lot. Inspection equipment shall be in accordance with 4.4.3."

4.5.1.2: Delete 4.5.1.2 in its entirety and substitute the following:

"4.5.1.2 Method 2. The propellant in a container shall be weighed and then checkweighed 100 percent on a different balance and if performed manually, by another production operator (no adding or subtracting of propellant shall be done during the checkweighing operation). The propellant shall then be placed in the bag and the bag sewn. The weight of the loaded bag should be checked as a major defect using a sampling plan from MIL-STD-105 or MIL-STD-1235 with an AQL of 0.40 percent. The weight of the propellant will be determined by subtracting an average weight as marked on the individual bag from the loaded increment weight".

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4.5.2: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI".

4.5.2.1: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI".

PAGE 27

4.5.2.2: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI" in three places.

4.5.4, second sentence: Delete "shall be rejected" and substitute "shall be removed".

4.5.5: Delete "BPI" and substitute "SPI".

4.5.6: Delete "(± 2 degrees F)" and substitute "(± 2.5 degrees F)".

PAGE 28

4.5.6.1:

Delete "Ten (10) zone 1 and ten (10) zone 5 charges" and substitute "Seven (7) zone 1 and seven (7) zone 5 charges".

Delete "(± 2 degrees F)" and substitute "factor 0.68".

Add the following paragraph:

"4.5.7 Charge removal from container. Each sample shall be tested for removal of the propelling charge from the container by hand. The charge may be pulled out by the straps or the container may be inverted and the charge either pulled out or slid out. Any charges that cannot be removed from the container using the above method shall be cause for rejection of the production represented by the sample."

5.1:

Delete paragraph 5.1 in its entirety and substitute the following:

"5.1 Preservation and packaging. N/A

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. The propelling charges shall be packed, sealed and tested in accordance with specified requirements of drawings 7548187/12913754.

5.2.2 Level B. Pack the same as Level A.

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5.2.3 Level C. Pack the same as Level A.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with specified requirements of drawings 7548187/12913754.

5.4 Unitization. The propelling charges from paragraph 5.1 shall be unitized in accordance with drawing 19-48-4231/53B."

PAGE 29

* Add the following paragraph:

"6.12 First article test. The first article test is a one time qualification test for a new contractor to load, assemble and pack acceptable M3A1 propelling charges. Once a contractor has demonstrated the ability to load, assemble and pack the M3A1 propelling charges, the first article test may be waived by the contracting officer. The following test program shall be used for the first article test:

TABLE III
First article test

Test Phase	Temp (deg F)	No. Control Rounds	No. Test Rounds	TECOM TOP
Propellant	70		10	TOP-4-2-504
Checkout	145		10	TOP-4-2-504
	-60		10	TOP-4-2-504
Sequential	145	15	60	TOP-4-2-504
Environmental	-60	15	60	TOP-4-2-504"

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